



PARENT

Parent Guide

Daily care updates, messages, billing, payments, schedule, and account

September 2026 · v1

Sign in at
mdo.timothystl.org

Sample data only. The children, messages, invoice numbers, card details, and confirmation numbers shown in these screenshots are fictional demo data — not a real family's information. Never share your PIN or a full card number in a message.

Timothy Lutheran Church — Mother's Day Out
6704 Fyler Ave, St. Louis, MO 63139 · (314) 781-8673 · mdo@timothystl.org

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Start here

Where to go. The Parent Portal lives at mdo.timothystl.org/parent — bookmark it, or use the link the center emailed you when your family was enrolled. It works on a phone, tablet, or computer, and stays signed in on a personal device.

The portal has six areas: **Today**, **Recap**, **Schedule**, **Billing**, **Messages**, and **Account**. If you have more than one enrolled child, use the child switcher near the top of Today, Recap, Schedule, or Messages to swap between them.

What parents do — and what staff do

- **Staff record** the physical arrival and departure from the classroom. Parents do not tap a "check in" button in the Parent Portal — the classroom team does that on their own room tablet or phone.
- Parents use **Today** to confirm a child's arrival was recorded and to follow care updates through the day.
- Parents use **Messages** for child-specific, non-urgent communication with the classroom and office.
- Parents use **Billing** to review issued invoices and make a secure online payment.
- **For an urgent pickup, health, or safety issue, call the center** at (314) 781-8673 instead of relying on an app message.

Sign in



Welcome. Receive. Grow. Go.



Parent

Sign in to your account

Email Address

PIN

Sign In

Each parent has their own PIN. [Forgot your PIN?](#)

[Register for care days](#)

[View my schedule](#)

Staff sign in at [the staff app](#). Administrators sign in at [the admin portal](#).

Parent Portal sign-in at mdo.timothystl.org/parent

1. **Go to** mdo.timothystl.org in any browser, or tap the myMDO shortcut if you saved one to your home screen.
2. **Enter** the email address on file for your family account.
3. **Enter your PIN**, then tap **Sign In**. PINs are 4–8 digits and are set per parent — you and your co-parent each have your own.

Your session normally stays signed in on a personal device. On a shared device, open **Account** and tap **Sign out** when you're finished. Several incorrect attempts will lock the account — contact the office if the app says it's locked. If you forgot your PIN, use **Forgot your PIN?** on the sign-in screen and follow the email instructions.

Registering for the first time, or just checking your schedule? The sign-in screen also links to **Register for care days** (the monthly calendar registration form) and **View my schedule** (a quick lookup) — you don't need a portal account for either one.

Follow today's care

Hi, Jordan.

Here is Emma's day at MDO.

Emma — 1 oah

Picture day — Thursday

Please send Emma in her blue myMDO shirt.

Emma Lee

Explorers Room

ON FILE FOR EMMA

Peanut allergy

MINOR INCIDENT

10:52 AM

Scraped left knee on the playground.

Cleaned, bandaged, and returned to play.
Full report signed by staff.

- **Checked in by Ms. Morgan**
8:18 AM

- **Morning snack — banana & crackers**
9:30 AM

- 2 ● **Outside play**
10:22 AM

- **Lunch — turkey, peas, pears, milk**
11:38 AM

- **Nap time**



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Today: the current day's care timeline

Recap

Emma

Noah

Monday

August 31, 2026

mm/dd/yyyy



Fri 28

Sat 29

Sun 30

Mon 31

MINOR INCIDENT NOTED

Emma scraped her left knee outside.
Cleaned, bandaged, and returned to play.

● Checked in

8:18 AM

● Morning snack

9:30 AM

● Outside play

10:22 AM

● Lunch

11:38 AM



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Recap: browse any earlier day

1. Use the **child switcher** at the top when your family has more than one child enrolled.
2. Look for a **Checked in** event near the top of the timeline once classroom staff receive your child. A later **Checked out** event records departure.
3. Read events in time order: meals and snacks, naps, diapers, outside time, supply needs, and photos.
4. An **allergy or care-note** card sits above the timeline whenever one is on file — it's worth a glance the first time you sign in, and the app will ask you to confirm it's still accurate.
5. A red **incident notice** appears above the timeline if one was filed. Follow the center's instructions for any signature or follow-up it asks for.
6. Open **Recap** to pick an earlier date and read that day's full timeline the same way.

A delayed update does not always mean care was missed. Staff may be helping children or the classroom device may briefly be offline. Refresh later. Call the center at (314) 781-8673 when confirmation is time-sensitive.

A simple daily routine

1. **After drop-off:** open Today and confirm the check-in appears.
2. **During the day:** glance at meals, naps, diapering, and photos as your schedule allows.
3. **Before pickup:** check for any announcement or incident notice.
4. **After pickup:** use Recap for a full, unhurried read of the day.

Message your child's team

Messages

Emma • 2 new

Noah

1

Ms. Morgan

Emma had a great morning.
Could you send an extra
change of clothes tomorrow?

9:46 AM

You

Absolutely — I'll put them in
her bag tonight.

10:02 AM • Read

MDO Office

Reminder: the center will
close at 4:00 PM Friday for
staff training.

1:05 PM

2

Message your teacher...

Send

3



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Messages: one conversation per child

1. Open **Messages**. A badge on the tab bar signals unread activity.
2. Choose the correct child before writing — **each child has a separate thread**, so the right classroom team sees it.
3. Type a concise message and tap **Send**. The child's classroom team and the office can both read the thread.
4. Watch the delivery label beneath your message: it changes from sent to read once a staff member opens the thread.

Good message topics include a routine schedule change, a non-urgent pickup note, a comfort-item reminder, or a follow-up to something a teacher mentioned. Include your child's name and the date whenever the context might be unclear.

Never send a card number, bank information, your PIN, a medical emergency, or an urgent same-day pickup change through Messages. Call the office at (314) 781-8673 for anything that needs an immediate confirmation.

Billing and paying online

The Billing tab shows invoices the center has issued. The total shown is the unpaid balance across every issued invoice — not just the newest one.

Online card payments are entered directly into secure fields hosted by the center's payment processor, Stax; myMDO never sees or stores your full card number.

Step 1 — Review the balance

Billing

TOTAL BALANCE DUE

1 —

\$245.00

[Show breakdown](#)

2 —

Pay \$245.00 online

View all invoices

September, August



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Billing: total balance and issued invoices

1. Open **Billing** and check the family name and **total balance due**.
2. Tap **Show breakdown** to see how the total is spread across unpaid invoices.
3. Open **View all invoices** to review an invoice's number, bill date, care days, amount billed, payments already recorded, and remaining balance.
4. If something looks wrong, stop before paying and contact the office with the invoice number.

The main **Pay online** button pays the most recent unpaid invoice and can include older unpaid balances in the same charge. Read the breakdown before confirming the amount.

Step 2 — Enter the payment securely

Jordan Lee

jordan.lee@example.com

Contact info

(555) 010-0142 · jordan.lee@example.com

Edit >

Children

Photos and allergy information · 2 profiles

2 profiles
>

Approved pickup contacts

Add or remove authorized adults

3 contacts >



SECURE ONLINE PAYMENT

Pay \$245.00

Jordan Lee · Invoice INV-2048



Balance due: \$245.00

Card number

4242 4242 4242 4242

1

Expiration

CVV

09



2029



...

2



Save this card for next time

Pay

3

Card details are entered directly into our payment processor's own secure fields above — this app never sees or stores your card number.

Secure online payment — card fields belong to Stax, not myMDO

1. Confirm the amount shown. Some families see **Pay a different amount** when partial-payment support is turned on; a partial payment always applies to the oldest outstanding balance first and cannot exceed the total balance.
2. Enter the card number, expiration date, and security code in the secure fields.
3. Check **Save this card for next time** only on a personal device you trust — it stores an encrypted reference with Stax, not the card number, for a faster payment later.
4. Tap **Pay**, then wait for the result. Don't tap repeatedly or refresh the page while it's processing.

If the screen says the payment is still processing: wait a moment, return to Billing, and check whether the balance changed before trying again. This avoids an accidental duplicate charge.

Step 3 — Save the receipt

Billing

TOTAL BALANCE DUE

\$245.00

[Show breakdown](#)

Pay \$245.00 online

View all invoices

September, August



Payment received

Thank you, Jordan Lee.

\$245.00

1

2

Invoice

INV-2048

Paid on

Sep 1, 2026

Payment method

Visa ...4242

Confirmation #

DEMO-7F3A2

A copy of this receipt has been emailed to the address on file.

3

Done



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Payment confirmation and receipt

1. Look for the success message and verify the amount.
2. Record the confirmation number if you'll need it for a reimbursement or an office question.
3. A copy is emailed automatically to the address on file — return to Billing afterward to confirm the updated balance.

Payment troubleshooting

- **Invoice is missing:** only issued invoices appear here. Ask the office whether it's been sent yet.
- **Amount looks unexpected:** open the invoice and read the balance breakdown before paying.
- **Card is declined:** double-check the number, expiration, security code, and billing ZIP code, or try a different card. Your bank can usually give more detail than the payment screen does.
- **Payment succeeded but the balance looks unchanged:** allow a short processing window, then refresh. Contact the office with the confirmation number if it still doesn't match.
- **Need a correction or a refund:** contact the office at (314) 781-8673 or mdo@timothystl.org. Don't submit a second payment to try to offset the first.

Review or register your schedule

Schedule

Emma

Noah

1

2

September 2026		
TUE 1 Full	THU 3 Full	TUE 8 Full
THU 10 Half	TUE 15 Full	THU 17 Full

Invoice balance

\$245.00 due

3

Register for next month



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Schedule: booked days by child and month

1. Open **Schedule**, then choose the correct child at the top.
2. Use the month arrows to review booked care days. Each tile shows the date and whether it's a **Full** or **Half** day booking.
3. Read the invoice status and balance shown for that month. Open **Billing** when you need the full invoice detail or a payment.
4. Tap **Register for next month** to open Calendar Registration and select a new month of care days.

The Schedule tab itself is read-only. A day marked **locked** belongs to a standing recurring schedule and can't be removed here — contact the office to request a change. If a submitted date is missing, double-check the child and month first, then contact the office before paying an invoice that doesn't match what you expect.

Account, documents, and notifications

Jordan Lee

jordan.lee@example.com

Contact info

(555) 010-0142 · jordan.lee@example.com

[Edit >](#)

Children

Photos and allergy information · 2 profiles

[2 profiles >](#)

Approved pickup contacts

Add or remove authorized adults

[3 contacts >](#)

Notifications

Daily activity, announcements, messages, billing

[Review >](#)

Documents

Incident reports, forms, immunization, statements

[Open >](#)

Documents

[Sign out](#)



Today



Recap



Schedule



Billing



Messages



Account

Account: family access, contacts, preferences, and documents

1. Open **Account** and verify your name, email, and phone number. Use **Edit** to update your phone number and confirm the new value was saved.
2. Open **Children** to review each profile photo and allergy information. Contact the office for legal-name, custody, medical, or other safety-critical corrections.
3. Open **Approved pickup contacts** to add or remove an authorized adult per the center's policy. Recheck the saved list before relying on it for pickup.
4. Open **Notifications** and choose alerts for daily activity, announcements, messages, and billing. Your device or browser may also need to allow notification permission.
5. Open **Documents** for incident reports, center policies and forms, immunization or medical uploads, statements, and a year-end childcare tax statement.
6. On a shared device, return to Account and tap **Sign out** when finished.

Keep pickup contacts and your phone number current. For a legal-name, custody, allergy, or other safety-critical change, contact the office directly so staff can confirm the update — some of those changes are intentionally not self-service.

Parent quick reference

I need to...	Go to	Best action
Confirm my child arrived	Today	Look for the staff-recorded check-in event
Review yesterday (or another day)	Recap	Choose the date and read the full timeline
Ask a non-urgent question	Messages	Select the right child, write clearly, watch Sent/Read
See what's owed	Billing	Review the total due, the breakdown, and invoice detail
Pay securely	Billing → Pay online	Confirm the amount, use the secure fields, save the receipt
See booked days	Schedule	Review by child/month; contact the office for locked-day changes
Change alerts or pickup contacts	Account	Update, save, and verify the result
Get a year-end tax statement	Account → Documents	Download once payments for the period are on file

Timothy Lutheran Mother's Day Out

6704 Fyler Ave, St. Louis, MO 63139

Office: **(314) 781-8673** (tel:+13147818673) · Email: **mdo@timothystl.org**
(mailto:mdo@timothystl.org)

Parent Portal: **mdo.timothystl.org/parent** (<https://mdo.timothystl.org/parent>)

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Screens shown use fictional demo data. Center-specific rooms, rates, policies, and contacts may differ.